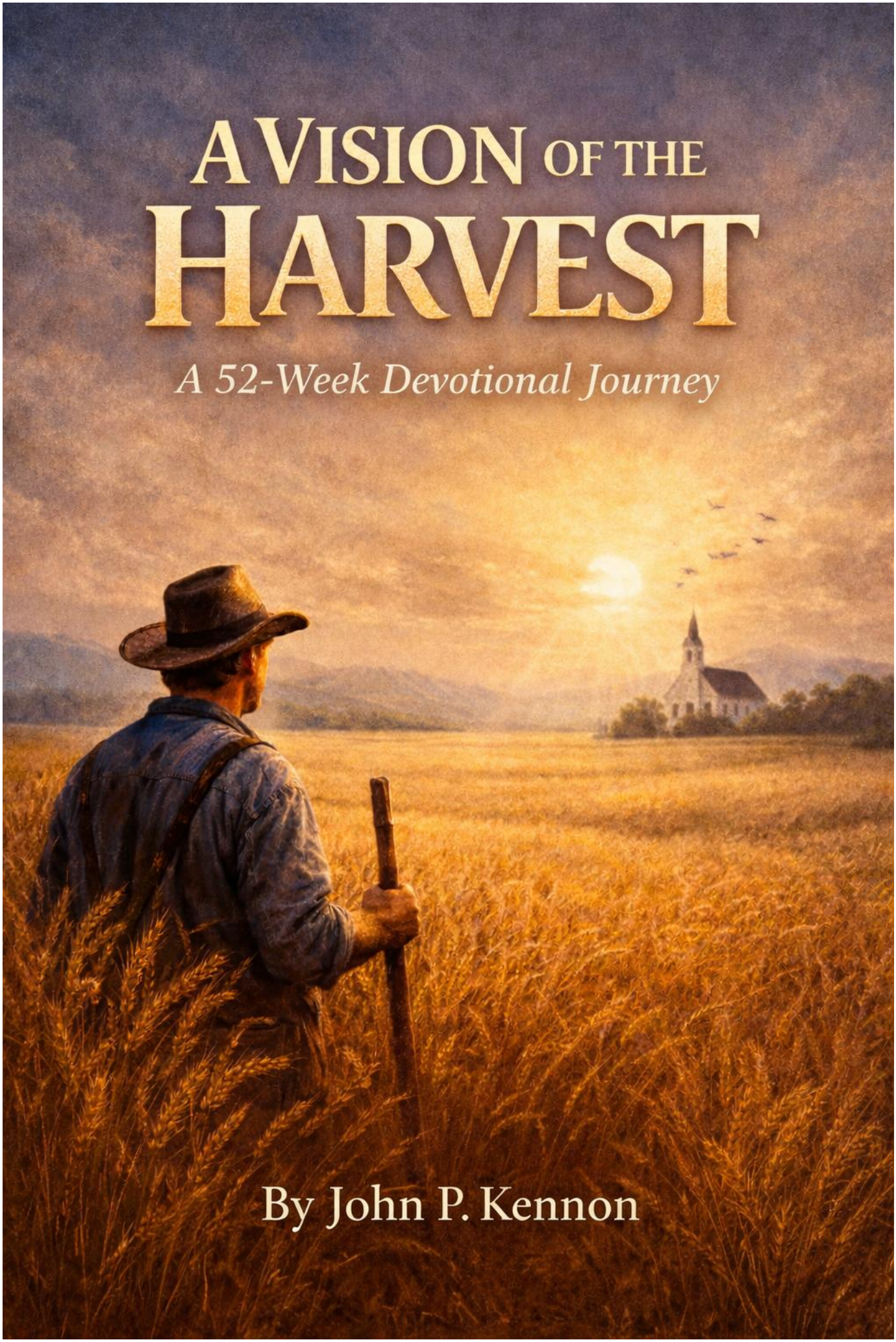

A VISION OF THE HARVEST
A 52-Week Devotional Journey
By John P. Kennon

Preface

A Vision of the Harvest

The title of this work was born out of an experience the Lord gave me several years ago—an experience that has never left me.

I was playing the drums during a church service in Fort Worth, Texas, when something unexpected unfolded in my spirit. I am not one given to hype or glorifying the unusual, but the Lord impressed upon me the importance of remembering what He reveals. As the service concluded, I remained seated behind the drums, looking out over the congregation. In my mind's eye, I suddenly saw the people before me not merely as individuals in a room, but as a vast field—ripe and ready for harvest.

The Lord invited me to step down from my vantage point and walk with Him into the field. As we moved together, He began revealing truths about the harvest—simple in concept, yet profound in meaning. He showed me stalks of corn that were well-pollinated and full, some with five or six ears, mature and ready to be gathered. Others were only partially grown, bearing just two or three ears. Some had grown too closely together, stunted and unpollinated. I saw stalks with no ears at all—wilted, dying in the field. Yet right beside them were others standing strong and healthy.

As these images unfolded, understanding followed. The field, the Lord showed me, is humanity upon the earth. For thousands of years God has been planting, watering, and reaping the souls of men and women. From the beginning of time, His grace has worked tirelessly to redeem mankind. Faith, I came to understand, is the avenue through which God works upon the heart.

Some are growing.
Some are wounded.
Some are dying.
Some are healthy.
Some are recovering.

Yet all remain under God's sovereign care and command.

The laborers are those of us who work in the field. As Scripture declares, *"Paul planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase"* (1 Corinthians 3:6). We are called to plant and to water—to sow seeds of faith and to tend what God has entrusted to us—while always remembering that the harvest itself belongs to the Lord.

This realization raised sobering questions in my heart:
How do we do the work?
What should we say?
Why is fulfilling the Great Commission so vital?

These are the questions I seek to address in the pages that follow.

Over more than three decades of serving in various forms of outreach, the Lord has placed within me a growing burden for His harvest. That burden has compelled me not only to labor, but to teach—to help equip others who desire to be used of God. The results are always in His hands; I offer only what He has taught me, trusting Him to give the increase.

My prayer is this: that the words of this devotional would shape your heart and sharpen your vision. That you would receive wisdom, grow in understanding, and walk with renewed purpose. May your love for God deepen, your compassion for souls increase, and your clarity concerning His work be strengthened.

And most of all, may your time be filled with the joy and honor of laboring in the Kingdom of God.

Sincerely,
John P. Kennon

A VISION OF THE HARVEST

This book is a **52-week devotional journey**, written to form that understanding over time—**converting evangelism from an occasional event into a lived, daily lifestyle**. It is not designed to create busyness, but to shape believers who live sent, think intentionally, and obey faithfully in ordinary life.

A Vision of the Harvest

God has always been a God of harvest.

From the opening pages of Scripture to the final invitation of Revelation, His desire has never wavered—that none should perish, but that all should come to repentance (2 Peter 3:9). Revival has never begun with programs, momentum, or emotional intensity. It has always begun with God's burden for lost souls.

Salvation is not sustained by human effort or religious structure. It is founded entirely upon the faithfulness of God. He alone initiates redemption, completes it, and preserves it. Like a loving Father who pities His children, God looks upon a world that is weary, scattered, and without a shepherd—and He is moved with compassion.

Yet God has chosen to work through people.

He is building His Church—not in isolation, but through yielded vessels. From the promise in Genesis that the seed of the woman would bruise the head of the serpent, to Jesus' declaration that the gates of hell would not prevail against His Church, God has always advanced His kingdom through willing obedience. Though individuals may falter, the Church endures—because God Himself sustains it.

This is not merely theology.
It is responsibility.

The Call of the Great Commission

Once a person is saved, the question becomes unavoidable: *What do we do next?*

Jesus answered plainly:

"Go ye therefore, and teach all nations…"
—Matthew 28:19

The Great Commission is not a suggestion, an experiment, or a church program. It is a calling—a divine invitation to participate in bringing the will of God in heaven into fulfillment on earth. Every believer is commissioned. The saints are no more exempt from outreach than ministers are exempt from obedience.

- The work continues until the door of grace is closed.
- This devotional is built on one foundational truth: **evangelism is not an event—it is a way of life.**
- It is not about creating busyness, but about forming believers who live sent.

The Yoke of Christ

We are saved by grace through faith—not by works, but by His finished work. Yet grace does not remove responsibility; it redefines it.

Our yoke—self-effort, pressure, fear, performance—is heavy and exhausting. Christ's yoke is different. It is pure, fruitful, and eternal. Trying to build the Church without God is like attempting to construct a building without materials. This is not a temporary project. It is an eternal work, and eternal work requires eternal tools: faith, obedience, prayer, and submission—not ambition or clever ideas.

Jesus never asked us to carry the harvest.
He asked us to walk with Him in it.

The Laborers Are Few

God is not lacking souls to save.
He is lacking laborers.

Laborers are not sent because they merely have time; they are sent because they have been prepared. Spiritual maturity comes through instruction, discipline, and testing—so that spiritual senses are exercised to discern both good and evil. This work is not driven by programs, but by Spirit-led people—people who know when to plant, when to water, and when to trust God to give the increase.

God alone gives the increase.
Our calling is faithfulness.

Finding the Burden

A true burden is never self-generated—it is placed by the Lord. It is discovered through prayer, preaching, humility, and a willingness to be available. This is not about striving to be used by God; it is about yielding so that God may work through us.

Ambition must give way to submission.
Availability must precede assignment.

Getting the Job Done

Scripture teaches that our feet must be shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace (Ephesians 6:15). Preparation matters. It includes understanding the Great Commission, trusting God to work through us, and learning to rightly divide the Word of truth.

Every believer has a role—whether visible or unseen:
personal evangelism, discipleship, care, encouragement, faithful service, and quiet obedience. Being used of God is not reserved for pulpits or platforms. It is often found in prayer meetings, family devotions, service, and simple faithfulness.

Millions of small, obedient acts form the never-ending Kingdom of God.

Responsibility Begins at Home

One of the greatest losses in the Church is generational momentum. Faith must be nurtured—from new birth into maturity—within homes before it can be sustained in congregations. The spiritual response of a household often reveals whether teaching has truly taken root.

When faith is lived at home, it endures beyond us.

An Invitation, Not a Formula

This devotional is not rushed.
It is not shallow.
It is not program-driven.

It is designed to shape a life.

A life that sees the harvest.
Walks by faith.
Does the work.
Builds legacy.

May this journey form in you what God desires to release through you—faithfully, steadily, and eternally.

The harvest is ready. The invitation stands. Will you walk into it?

A Call to Everyday Faithfulness

Ministry does not begin with a microphone, a platform, or a title.
It begins with availability.

God uses willing hands in hospitals and hallways, living rooms and lunch tables, streets and sanctuaries. The harvest is wide—and the work is varied.

Where Obedience Takes Shape is after we pray and ask the Lord, "where do you want me to work?"

1. Hospitals & Care Facilities

- Visiting the sick
- Praying with families
- Reading Scripture
- Offering quiet presence
- Extended Bible study for those searching

2. Nursing Homes

- Personal visitations
- Church services
- Family encouragement and outreach

3. Jail & Prison Ministry

- One-on-one Bible studies
- Group Bible classes
- Special services and concerts
- Family-focused outreach

4. Street & Community Outreach

- Storefront or parking-lot services
- Outdoor worship and concerts
- Personal invitations and follow-up
- Prayer requests and Bible studies
- Building relationships that lead to church connection

5. Special Services & Events

- Sing-ins and worship gatherings
- Youth-focused outreach
- Theme-based services
- Evangelistic preaching

6. Bible Studies & Discipleship

- Personal evangelism
- Follow-up with visitors
- Discipleship classes for new believers

7. Spanish & Multilingual Outreach

- Interpretation services
- Bible studies in native languages
- Distribution of gospel materials

8. Bus & Transportation Ministry

- Bus routes
- Van routes
- Carpools
- *Whatever it takes to get people to church*

9. Care & Encouragement

- Following up with absent saints
- Caring for new parents
- Supporting the sick and elderly

10. Benevolence

- Personal giving
- Church-organized assistance
- Meeting needs beyond human control

11. Media & Communication

- Radio Bible studies
- Teaching programs
- Inspirational preaching

Ministry Behind the Scenes Still Counts

Being “used of God” often looks like:

- Prayer meetings
- Church work days
- Personal evangelism

- Family devotions and prayer
- Inviting neighbors
- Cleaning, setting up, tearing down
- Making copies, flyers, invitations
- Doing the unnoticed work faithfully

Heaven keeps better records than people.

And faithfulness unseen on earth is never unseen by God.

The Common Thread

All of this flows from:

- Prayer
- Training
- Obedience
- Rightly dividing the Word
- Trusting God to work through ordinary people

Millions of small, faithful acts build an eternal Kingdom.

The devotional is outlined into quarters and then broken down into weekly topics.

This devotional is not designed to create busyness—but to form believers who live sent.

QUARTER 1 — SEEING THE HARVEST

Theme: God's Burden & God's Vision
(Weeks 1–13)

Before we work, we must *see*. Before we go, we must *connect* with God.

Month 1: God's Burden

Weeks 1–4

1. God's Heart for the Lost
2. The Weight of What God Sees
3. Compassion Before Commission
4. Why Indifference Is the Enemy of Revival

Month 2: The Field Is Ready

Weeks 5–8
5. The Harvest Is Plenteous
6. Why the Laborers Are Few
7. Seeing People, Not Problems
8. When Burden Becomes Calling

Month 3: Finding Your Burden

Weeks 9–13
9. God Uses Willing Vessels
10. Faith Before Ability
11. The Cost of Saying Yes
12. Carrying the Burden Without Burning Out
13. Consecration as Preparation

QUARTER 2 — WALKING IN FAITH

Theme: The Yoke, Dominion, and Trust
(Weeks 14–26)

Faith is not passive belief—it is obedient movement.

Month 4: The Yoke Is Easy

Weeks 14–17
14. Resting While Working

15. Grace-Fueled Obedience
16. Letting Go of Control
17. Trusting God With Outcomes

Month 5: Dominion & Authority

Weeks 18–21
18. Dominion Begins in the Heart
19. Authority Through Submission
20. Faith That Pushes Back Darkness
21. Why the Enemy Resists Growth

Month 6: Living by Faith

Weeks 22–26
22. Faith in the Ordinary
23. When Faith Is Tested
24. Obedience Without Applause
25. Faith That Endures Delay
26. Faith That Reproduces

QUARTER 3 — DOING THE WORK

Theme: Labor, Evangelism, and Action
(Weeks 27–39)

Vision without action is spiritual procrastination.

Month 7: Getting the Job Done

Weeks 27–30
27. Trained, Not Just Willing
28. Discipline in the Kingdom
29. Spiritual Preparation for Practical Work
30. Excellence Honors God

Month 8: Evangelism Is All-Consuming

Weeks 31–35
31. Everyday Evangelism
32. Living as a Witness
33. Seeds, Not Statistics
34. Faithful Sowing
35. Leaving the Results to God

Month 9: Kingdom Mindset

Weeks 36–39
36. Thinking Beyond Self
37. The Cost of Comfort
38. Living Sent
39. The Church on Mission

QUARTER 4 — LEGACY & MULTIPLICATION

Theme: Family, Continuity, and Finishing Well
(Weeks 40–52)

Revival that doesn't transfer dies.

Month 10: Responsibility to Our Family

Weeks 40–43
40. Ministry Starts at Home
41. Modeling Faith Daily
42. Teaching by Living
43. Building Altars in the Home

Month 11: God's Kingdom Is Never-Ending

Weeks 44–48
44. Generational Faith
45. Passing the Torch
46. Multiplication Over Addition
47. Legacy Over Popularity
48. Preparing the Next Laborers

Month 12: The Conclusion of the Whole Matter

Weeks 49–52
49. Faithful to the End
50. Finishing Your Assignment
51. When the Harvest Comes In
52. "Well Done, Good and Faithful Servant"

WEEK 1 — GOD'S HEART FOR THE LOST

Quarter 1: Seeing the Harvest

The Moment (A Relatable Reality)

We live surrounded by people and still feel strangely alone.

Grocery store aisles full. Highways packed. Phones buzzing nonstop.
And yet—so many hearts are quietly empty.

We've learned how to scroll past pain, how to tune out brokenness, how to stay busy enough not to feel the weight of the world around us. Life is loud. Schedules are full. Emotional bandwidth is thin. And somewhere along the way, *compassion became optional*.

Not because we don't care—but because caring costs something.

God has never struggled with that problem.

The Word (Scriptural Application)

"When He saw the multitudes, He was moved with compassion for them, because they were weary and scattered, like sheep having no shepherd."
— Matthew 9:36

Jesus didn't just *notice* the crowds.
He felt them.

The word *compassion* here means more than sympathy—it speaks of a deep, internal stirring. A holy ache. A burden that presses inward before it ever moves outward.

The people weren't rebellious. They weren't hostile.
They were weary.
They were scattered.
They were leaderless.

And Jesus did not respond with irritation, distance, or judgment.
He responded with *burden*.

This is the beginning of every true work of God.
Before preaching. Before miracles. Before sending laborers.

God's heart breaks first.

If we ever lose that, we may still be active—but we won't be effective.

The Prayer (Alignment)

Read together or aloud as a family.

Lord, give us Your eyes.
Not eyes that criticize, but eyes that see.
Not hearts that rush past pain, but hearts that are moved by it.

Break us free from indifference.
Soften what life has hardened.
Restore compassion where we have learned to cope instead of care.

Let us feel what You feel.
Carry what You carry.
And love the way You love—without condition, without fear, without delay.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

The Table (Family Action)

Family Discussion (10–15 minutes):

Ask these questions around the table or living room:

1. Who do we see every week that might be tired, lonely, or overwhelmed?
2. Why do you think it's sometimes easier to stay busy than to care deeply?
3. What do you think God feels when He looks at our city, our school, our workplace?

Action Step (Simple & Concrete):

This week, pray daily for one person by name who may be weary or scattered.
No fixing. No confronting. Just intentional prayer.

Write the name down. Place it where the family can see it.

Faith begins when compassion becomes personal.

Closing Thought for the Week

You don't have to save the world.
You just have to see it the way God does.

Everything else flows from there.

WEEK 2 — THE WEIGHT OF WHAT GOD SEES

Quarter 1: Seeing the Harvest

The Moment (A Relatable Reality)

There are things we can't unsee.

A headline that lingers.
A conversation that hits too close.
A look on someone's face that tells you *something is wrong*, even if no words are spoken.

We try to shake it off. We distract ourselves. We stay busy.
But some moments don't leave quietly. They follow us home.

That's because not all weight is meant to be dropped.
Some weight is meant to be carried.

The Word (Scriptural Application)

"I have surely seen the affliction of my people… and have heard their cry… for I know their sorrows."
— Exodus 3:7

Before God ever delivered Israel, He saw them.
Before power was displayed, pain was acknowledged.

God does not act from distance.
He acts from awareness.

Notice the progression:

- *I have seen…*
- *I have heard…*
- *I know their sorrows…*

This is not casual observation.
This is intimate involvement.

When God allows us to see something that weighs on us, it is often because He is inviting us to share—just a little—in what He already carries fully.

Burden is not condemnation.
Burden is participation.

The Prayer (Alignment)

Pray slowly. Let the words breathe.

Lord, teach us the difference
between distraction and discernment.

Help us not to numb what You are awakening.
Not to flee what You are revealing.

Give us wisdom to carry the weight You assign—
not anxiety, not fear, not false responsibility—
but holy burden.

Let what moves You move us.
Let what grieves You shape our prayers.

We trust You with what we cannot fix.
We offer You what we cannot ignore.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

The Table (Family Action)

Family Discussion:

1. Has there ever been something you couldn't stop thinking about—even when you tried?
2. What do you think the difference is between *worry* and *burden*?
3. How can we tell when God is drawing our attention to something on purpose?

Action Step:

This week, choose one moment of intentional stillness as a family.

- No phones
- No TV
- No background noise

Sit quietly for 2–3 minutes and ask God one simple question:

"Lord, what do You want us to notice?"

No forcing answers. No pressure to speak.
Just space for God to whisper.

Closing Thought for the Week

Not every weight is meant to crush you.
Some are meant to position you.

God never burdens us to overwhelm us—
He burdens us to prepare us.

WEEK 3 — COMPASSION BEFORE COMMISSION

Quarter 1: Seeing the Harvest

The Moment (A Relatable Reality)

We live in a world obsessed with outcomes.

Get results.
Make an impact.
Do something *useful*.

Even in faith, it's tempting to skip the heart work and rush straight to action. We want to fix, correct, advise, or respond—often before we've fully listened or understood.

But hurried hands rarely heal well.

God has never been impressed by speed.
He has always been drawn to love.

The Word (Scriptural Application)

"Then Jesus went about all the cities and villages, teaching… preaching… and healing… But when He saw the multitudes, He was moved with compassion…"
— Matthew 9:35–36

Notice the order.

Jesus ministered, yes—but what *moved* Him wasn't obligation.
It was compassion.

And what followed compassion?

"Then saith He unto His disciples, The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few."
— Matthew 9:37

The commission didn't come first.
The compassion did.

When ministry flows without compassion, it becomes mechanical.
When action outruns love, people become projects.

God never sends us to a harvest He hasn't first taught us to love.

The Prayer (Alignment)

Pray this with intention—especially if action comes easily for you.

Lord, slow us down where we are too fast.
Soften us where we have become efficient but distant.

Teach us to love people before we try to lead them.
To feel before we speak.
To see before we act.

Purify our motives.
Let nothing we do be driven by pride, pressure, or performance.

Give us Your compassion—
the kind that moves us to action without losing tenderness.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

The Table (Family Action)

Family Discussion:

1. Why do you think it's sometimes easier to *do something* than to *feel something*?
2. Have you ever felt rushed or misunderstood by someone who was trying to help?
3. How do you think compassion changes the way people receive truth?

Action Step:

This week, practice listening before responding.

Choose one conversation where:

- You don't interrupt
- You don't correct
- You don't offer solutions

Just listen fully.

Then pray silently for the person before you speak.

That is compassion in motion.

Closing Thought for the Week

God does not send hearts that haven’t been shaped.
He does not commission hands He hasn’t first softened.

Compassion is not weakness.
It is the gate through which true ministry flows.

WEEK 4 — WHY INDIFFERENCE IS THE ENEMY OF REVIVAL

Quarter 1: Seeing the Harvest

The Moment (A Relatable Reality)

Indifference doesn't look like rebellion.

It looks like *normal*.

Bills paid. Routines kept. Faith acknowledged.
Life moving along just fine.

No anger toward God. No resistance to truth.
Just… no urgency.

And that's the problem.

Indifference rarely announces itself.
It settles in quietly—when we stop being disturbed by what once moved us, when pain becomes background noise, when spiritual hunger is replaced with spiritual familiarity.

The most dangerous season is not when people oppose God—
It's when they no longer expect Him to move.

The Word (Scriptural Application)

"I know thy works, that thou art neither cold nor hot… because thou art lukewarm… I will spue thee out of my mouth."
— Revelation 3:15–16

These were not atheists.
These were not persecutors.
These were God's people—busy, functional, self-sufficient.

They weren't *cold*—openly resistant.
They weren't *hot*—fully surrendered.

They were lukewarm.

Indifference doesn't deny God's existence.
It denies His urgency.

And revival cannot live where nothing is felt.

The Prayer (Alignment)

This is a heart-searching prayer. Pray honestly.

Lord, search us where we've grown comfortable.
Expose the places where familiarity has replaced fire.

Forgive us for moments when we cared just enough
to feel spiritual—but not enough to be changed.

Awaken us again.
Disturb our peace where it has numbed our compassion.

Let us never grow so settled
that we stop longing for You to move.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

The Table (Family Action)

Family Discussion:

1. What does indifference look like in everyday life?
2. Why do you think it's easier to drift than to stay passionate?
3. How can we help each other stay spiritually awake?

Action Step:

This week, identify one spiritual habit that has become routine instead of meaningful.

- Prayer
- Worship
- Scripture
- Church attendance

As a family, intentionally slow it down and re-engage it with purpose.

Less volume.
More attention.

Closing Thought for the Week

Revival doesn't begin with crowds. It begins with concern. Indifference is not neutral ground. It is the quiet enemy of everything God wants to do.

End of sample

Thank you for reading the opening of
A Vision of the Harvest.

The full edition is being prepared
for publication.

highergroundministries.church